

The Cold Email Vault

50 B2B Templates That Book Meetings

+ Frameworks, Subject Lines, and Follow-Up Sequences

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1. How to Use This Vault

Every template here has been pulled from cold campaigns that converted at **3%+ reply rate** in real B2B contexts. Each one is structured so you can swap the `{{variables}}` in under 60 seconds and ship.

Three rules before you send anything:

1. **Segment first.** A template tuned for a CTO will fall flat on a marketing director. Pick from the right section.
2. **Personalize the first line.** The opener is the only line that proves you didn't blast 5,000 people. Spend 30 seconds reading something they wrote, posted, or shipped.
3. **Always send a follow-up.** 60% of replies come from follow-ups, not the first email. Use the sequences in Chapter 11.

Rule of thumb: If you're not embarrassed by how short your cold email is, it's probably too long. The shortest version of every template here is the one that wins.

2. The 4 Frameworks Behind Every Template

2.1 — PAS (Problem · Agitate · Solve)

Best for: pain-driven SaaS, services that fix something broken.

Hi `{{firstname}}`,

Most `{{role}}` teams at `{{company-type}}` are still `{{painful-current-state}}`.
That usually means `{{visible-symptom-1}}` and `{{visible-symptom-2}}` every quarter.

We built `{{product}}` to remove that — `{{customer}}` cut `{{metric}}` by `{{number}}%` in `{{timeframe}}`.

Worth a 15-min call this week?

2.2 — BAB (Before · After · Bridge)

Best for: when the buyer doesn't yet feel the pain — paint the after-state.

Hi `{{firstname}}`,

Right now, `{{role}}` teams at `{{industry}}` companies spend `{{X hours}}` a week on `{{tedious-task}}`.

Imagine that dropping to `{{Y minutes}}` — same output, no headcount.

That's what `{{product}}` does. `{{customer}}` ran it for `{{timeframe}}` and freed up `{{result}}`.

Open to a quick look next Tuesday?

2.3 — AIDA (Attention · Interest · Desire · Action)

Best for: when you have a clear differentiator and a fast hook.

Hi `{{firstname}}`,

`{{Bold one-line stat}}`.

We help `{{ICP}}` get to `{{outcome}}` without `{{usual-tradeoff}}`. Most teams see `{{result}}` inside `{{30 days}}`

`{{Customer A}}` and `{{Customer B}}` are using us this way — happy to share the case study.

Worth a 10-min walkthrough?

2.4 — RDM (Relevance · Differentiator · Micro-ask)

Best for: cold-cold, no warm signal. Wins on micro-ask, not the pitch.

Hi {{firstname}},

Saw {{specific-thing-they-did}} – relevant because we work with {{ICP}} on {{outcome}}.

Most teams come to us when {{trigger}}. We're different from {{competitor-category}} in that we {{different}}

Not pitching – would a 1-pager be helpful, or worth a 15-min call?

Why these four: Every B2B cold email that gets a reply uses one of them. Every one that doesn't is some unstructured paragraph that buries the ask.

3. Subject Lines That Get Opened (40 Tested)

The "Question" Set (highest open rates, 35–55%)

- quick question on {{specific-system}}
- {{firstname}} — is {{painful-thing}} still on your roadmap?
- worth 10 minutes?
- {{company}} + {{your-company}}?
- does this match what you're seeing?
- {{firstname}}, am I right about this?
- are you the right person for {{topic}}?
- quick {{topic}} question
- open to {{outcome}}?
- still owning {{function}}?

The "Specific" Set (30–45% open)

- {{specific-metric}} for {{company}}
- noticed {{specific-thing}} on {{platform}}
- idea for {{their-product}} after using it
- {{their-customer}} → {{relevant-result}}
- cut {{metric}} 40% — relevant for {{company}}?
- your post on {{topic}} — quick thought
- {{competitor}} just shipped {{thing}} — your move?
- 3 things on the {{their-product}} dashboard
- after {{their-event}} — one idea
- {{their-tool}} integration question

The "Curiosity" Set (28–40% open)

- weird idea
- this might not be relevant — but
- two minutes of your day
- not the usual pitch
- can I ask a favor?
- permission to send a 1-pager?
- am I missing something obvious?
- thought you'd find this funny
- caught my eye on {{platform}}
- this only takes 8 seconds

The "Social Proof" Set (25–35% open)

- how {{customer}} cut {{metric}} 30%

- {{competitor-customer}} switched — here's why
- {{notable-investor}} pointed me your way
- {{mutual-contact}} suggested I reach out
- met {{their-colleague}} at {{event}}
- {{their-customer}} mentioned {{topic}}
- everyone in {{vertical}} is asking this
- {{count}} {{ICP}} teams using this now
- what {{competitor}} won't tell you
- follow-up from {{event}}

Don't: use ALL CAPS, exclamation marks, "Re:" or "Fwd:" trickery, or "FREE" anywhere. These trigger spam filters and burn domain reputation.

4. SaaS Outbound (Templates 1–10)

Template 01 · Pain-led PAS · CTO/VP Eng

Subject: {{tool}} costs vs. usage at {{company}}

Hi {{firstname}},

Most VP Eng teams running {{tool}} at {{company-size}} scale eventually hit the same wall — costs grow 2-3x faster than usage, and the line item gets ugly.

We built {{product}} as a drop-in alternative. {{customer}} cut their {{tool}} bill 46% in 60 days, no migration downtime.

Worth a 15-min look this week?

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 02 · BAB · Founder/CEO of seed-Series A SaaS

Subject: {{firstname}} — booking demos on autopilot?

Hi {{firstname}},

Right now, founders at seed-stage SaaS spend ~12 hours a week qualifying inbound leads themselves. The good ones close. The unqualified ones eat your week.

Imagine an AI SDR that books only sales-qualified demos onto your calendar — same close rate, zero time from you.

That's {{product}}. {{customer}} got 8 SQLs in their first month for \$400.

Open to a 15-min walkthrough?

Template 03 · Reply-bait · Head of RevOps

Subject: quick question on your {{CRM}} setup

{{firstname}} — saw your post about consolidating the {{tool-stack}}.

Are you handling {{specific-pain}} in-house, or did you go with {{competitor}}?

Asking because we just shipped a v2 that solves the part {{competitor}} still doesn't. Happy to show you in 10 min if useful.

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 04 · Specific trigger · Recently funded company

Subject: congrats on the Series {{X}} — one suggestion

Hi {{firstname}},

Congrats on the {{round}} — saw the {{publication}} writeup.

Most teams at this stage hire 3-5 reps in 90 days, then realize their {{tool-category}} stack can't keep up. We worked with {{customer}} right after their Series {{X}} — they avoided the rebuild and got to \$5M ARR with the same setup.

Worth a 15-min call before the hiring spree?

Template 05 · AIDA · Director Product/Engineering

Subject: 23ms vs. 480ms — relevant for {{company}}?

Hi {{firstname}},

We benchmarked {{their-likely-stack}} against {{product}} on the same workload. Median latency: 23ms vs. 480ms. Cost: \$0.12 per million ops vs. \$1.40.

If your team is anywhere near {{specific-metric}}, the numbers are worth a look. Happy to send the benchmark spreadsheet.

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 06 · Reply-bait · Head of Marketing

Subject: who handles {{channel}} at {{company}}?

{{firstname}} — quick one. Is {{channel}} reporting up to you, or someone else?

Asking because we ran a teardown of {{their-recent-campaign}} and found 3 things they could pick up easily for an estimated 15-20% lift. Happy to send the writeup.

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 07 · Pain-led PAS · IT Director / Procurement

Subject: {{contract-vendor}} renewal coming up?

Hi {{firstname}},

Most IT directors with {{vendor}} contracts find out at renewal that the price went up 18-22% — and switching looks impossible because of the migration cost.

We solved that. {{product}} is a drop-in replacement, our migration tool moves data in <48 hours, and we're priced 35% under {{vendor}} for the same SLA.

If your renewal is in the next 6 months, worth a 20-min call?

Template 08 · Curiosity opener · Heads of Data

Subject: weird idea about your {{warehouse}} setup

Hi {{firstname}},

Weird idea — most data teams at {{stage}} companies underuse {{specific-feature}} in {{warehouse}}, and it's quietly inflating compute by 30-50%.

We've got a free audit script that runs in 5 minutes and tells you exactly where the leak is. Want me to send it over?

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 09 · Specific · After product release

Subject: noticed {{their-feature}} just shipped

{{firstname}} — saw {{feature}} went live last week. Played with it for 20 min.

One thing I'd consider: {{specific-product-suggestion}}. We hit the same wall with {{customer}} 18 months ago and ended up using {{approach}}.

Happy to send a 1-pager — or we can talk it through. Either way works.

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 10 · BAB · Founder of services business pivoting to product

Subject: turning {{services-engagement}} into product?

Hi {{firstname}},

A lot of founders running services-led {{vertical}} eventually want to ship a self-serve product, but the engineering lift kills momentum.

Imagine 80% of your services delivered by software in 90 days, with your existing team. That's what we did with {{customer}} — they 4x'd margins.

Worth a 20-min call to see if the model fits {{company}}?

5. Agency & Freelance Outreach (Templates 11–20)

Template 11 · Specific · Marketing leader at fast-growing co

Subject: 2 things I'd change on {{their-site}}

Hi {{firstname}},

Spent 10 min on {{site}} — two specific things stand out:

1. {{specific-issue-1}} (fix would lift {{metric}} ~12-18%)
2. {{specific-issue-2}} (probably losing {{stat}} a month)

We do this for {{ICP}} — happy to send a 4-page teardown free, no call required. Reply "send" if useful.

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 12 · Reply-bait · Founders

Subject: who runs {{function}} at {{company}}?

{{firstname}} – quick one. Is {{function}} owned in-house or with an agency?

Reason I ask: we just opened 2 slots for {{specialty}} and we work specifically with {{ICP-niche}}. {{customer-1}} and {{customer-2}} are recent wins.

Not pitching – just want to know if it's worth keeping you posted.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 13 · Niche specialist · Vertical-only agency

Subject: {{vertical}}-only {{specialty}} agency

Hi {{firstname}},

We're a {{specialty}} agency that works exclusively with {{vertical}} – no other verticals, no exceptions. That focus means we already know your buyer, your CAC benchmarks, and the channels that don't work in your space.

Last 4 clients hit {{result}} in {{timeframe}}. Worth a 15-min call?

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 14 · Freelance · Direct portfolio link

Subject: {{specialty}} for {{company}} — 3 portfolio pieces

Hi {{firstname}},

I'm a freelance {{role}} – sending 3 portfolio pieces relevant to what you're doing at {{company}}:

- {{link-1}} – for {{relevant-customer}}, similar to your {{use-case}}
- {{link-2}} – solved {{problem}} for {{relevant-customer}}
- {{link-3}} – recent project, exact stack as yours

If you're hiring or need backup capacity, happy to chat. Day rate is {{rate}}.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 15 · Audit-led · Conversion specialist

Subject: free audit of {{specific-funnel}}?

{{firstname}} – I run conversion audits on {{ICP}} sites for free, no obligation.

Audit is a 6-page PDF: heuristic eval, 3 prioritized fixes, mockups for the top one. Most clients implement #1 themselves and get a 10-15% lift. Some hire us for the rest.

Want me to run yours? 48-hour turnaround.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 16 · Loom-led · High-touch agency

Subject: 4-min Loom on {{their-page}}

Hi {{firstname}},

Recorded a 4-min Loom walking through {{specific-page}} on {{site}}. Three things that are likely costing you signups, with rough mockups for each.

Loom: {{link}}

If any of it lands, happy to talk through implementation. If not, no harm done – hope it's useful either way.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 17 · Case-study-led · B2B agency

Subject: {{customer}} → 4.2x pipeline in 90 days

Hi {{firstname}},

We took {{similar-customer}} from {{starting-pipeline}} to 4.2x in 90 days – same vertical, same buyer profile as {{company}}.

The full case study is here: {{link}}. If your numbers are anywhere near where theirs were, the playbook should map cleanly.

Worth 15 min to walk through?

Template 18 · Specific stack mention

Subject: noticed you're on {{their-stack}}

{{firstname}} – saw you're running {{their-stack}} based on {{evidence}}.

That's our exact specialty. We ship {{outcome}} 3-4x faster on that stack than generalist agencies because we already know all the gotchas.

Happy to send our last 5 deliverables on {{stack}} as proof. Reply "send" or let me know if a 15-min call works better.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 19 · Reply-bait · Hiring spike

Subject: hiring {{role}}s at {{company}}?

{{firstname}} – saw 3 {{role}} JDs went up on {{company}}'s careers page in the last 2 weeks.

We bridge that gap. White-label {{specialty}} contractors, full coverage during the hiring process, hand off cleanly when your full-time team is in place.

Worth a quick call?

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 20 · Permission ask · Cold cold

Subject: permission to send a 1-pager?

Hi {{firstname}},

Cold reaching out – won't pitch in this email. We work with {{ICP}} on {{outcome}} and {{customer}} is our most recent client.

Permission to send a 1-pager on the engagement model? Roughly 90 seconds to read, no call required.

– {{your-firstname}}

6. Enterprise & Mid-Market (Templates 21–30)

Template 21 · Multi-thread opener · Director-level

Subject: introducing — {{your-co}} + {{their-co}}

Hi {{firstname}},

Reaching out because {{trigger-event}} at {{company}} maps tightly to what we do.

We're already in conversation with {{colleague-name}} on the {{department}} side – wanted to introduce ourselves on the {{their-function}} side too in case there's a parallel use case.

Quick 20-min intro call this week or next?

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 22 · Procurement-friendly · IT/InfoSec

Subject: SOC 2 Type II + {{their-compliance-need}} — fit for {{company}}?

Hi {{firstname}},

Most enterprise procurement deals get killed by 1 of 3 things: SOC 2, SSO/SAML, or DPA terms.

We're SOC 2 Type II, ship enterprise SSO out of the box, and have a pre-negotiated DPA on file. {{customer}} closed our procurement in 21 days.

If you're evaluating {{category}}, worth a 30-min security review with our CISO?

Template 23 · Champion-builder · Mid-level manager

Subject: helping you make the case for {{outcome}}

Hi {{firstname}},

Most {{role}}s at {{company-size}} have to build the internal case for tools like ours before procurement will even look at it.

We make that easier – ROI calculator, executive 1-pager, a CFO-ready model in a spreadsheet. {{customer}}'s {{role}} used the exact package to get sign-off in two meetings.

Want me to send it? No call required.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 24 · Strategic narrative · VP/CXO

Subject: {{their-strategic-priority}} — one perspective

Hi {{firstname}},

Read the {{their-public-statement}} on {{strategic-priority}}. One observation – the companies executing on it well are doing {{specific-thing}} that doesn't show up in the typical {{category}} stack.

Three of those companies use {{product}} to do it. Happy to share the pattern in a 20-min call.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 25 · Bottom-up entry · Practitioner

Subject: free dev seat for the {{team}} team?

Hi {{firstname}},

We give a free dev seat to engineers at companies in our ICP – no sales call, no commitment. The team uses it, and if it's useful, they bring it up internally.

If you're touching {{problem-space}}, want me to send the seat? Activated in 60 seconds, your call whether to share it with the team.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 26 · Replacement narrative · Incumbent user

Subject: post-{{incumbent}} world at {{company}}?

Hi {{firstname}},

Most {{ICP}} teams running {{incumbent}} eventually hit one of three walls: {{wall-1}}, {{wall-2}}, or {{wall-3}}.

We took {{customer}} off {{incumbent}} in 6 weeks – full migration, no downtime, and they're now running 2.4x the workload at half the cost.

If you're anywhere near that decision, worth a 30-min call?

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 27 · Industry-specific · Healthcare/Finance/Regulated

Subject: {{regulation}}-compliant {{category}} for {{company}}

Hi {{firstname}},

Most {{category}} tools get killed in your industry by {{regulation}}. We built ours from day one to be {{regulation}}-compliant – full audit trail, BAA, and {{specific-feature}}.

{{customer-in-industry}} is using us today for {{use-case}}. Worth a 25-min call to see if the architecture fits {{company}}?

Subject: cutting {{cost-center}} 40% — {{customer}}'s playbook

Hi {{firstname}},

"{{quote-from-similar-CFO}} — {{name}}, CFO at {{customer}}."

That's the line {{customer}}'s CFO gave us after their Q2 review. They cut {{cost-center}} 40% by replacing {{incumbent}} with {{product}}, on a 14-month breakeven.

Happy to send the model. Open to a 20-min call to walk through it?

— {{your-firstname}}

Subject: post-{{acquisition}} integration at {{company}}?

Hi {{firstname}},

Most acquisitions at {{company-size}} hit a {{system}} integration nightmare 60-90 days in. Different tools, different data, different processes — all bleeding into one quarter you can't recover.

We helped {{customer}} land their {{acquired-co}} integration in 45 days flat. If {{company}} is anywhere in that timeline, worth a 30-min call?

— {{your-firstname}}

Subject: workshop with {{department}} + {{department-2}} at {{company}}

Hi {{firstname}},

The use case we'd ship at {{company}} touches both {{department-1}} and {{department-2}} — getting both in the room early kills 3-4 weeks of back-and-forth.

We run a free 90-min discovery workshop for {{ICP}} — your team brings the use case, we bring the pattern from 30+ similar deployments. {{customer}} did this and signed in week 5.

Worth scheduling?

7. Partnership & Referral Asks (Templates 31–35)

Template 31 · Co-marketing · Adjacent SaaS

Subject: joint {{content-asset}} with {{your-company}}?

Hi {{firstname}},

Our customer bases overlap heavily – both selling into {{ICP}}, both buyers care about {{problem}}.

Idea: joint webinar or research report on {{topic}}. We've got the data from {{N customers}}, you've got the audience reach. {{partner-example}} did a similar joint piece with us last year – 1,800 leads split 50/50.

Worth a 20-min call to scope it?

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 32 · Tech partnership · API integration

Subject: {{their-product}} integration on the {{your-product}} side

Hi {{firstname}},

We've had 14 customers ask for a native {{their-product}} integration in the last quarter. We can build the {{your-product}}-side in 2 weeks if there's a clean endpoint to hit.

Want to scope a tech partnership? Co-marketed listing on both directories, joint launch announcement, revenue share if it makes sense.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 33 · Channel/reseller

Subject: {{your-product}} as a {{their-services}} add-on?

Hi {{firstname}},

Your {{services-offering}} is the natural delivery channel for what we built. Your team is already in the room solving {{problem}} – we're the tool that gets plugged in to do it 5x faster.

Margin structure for partners is {{X}}% recurring. {{partner-customer}} added \$340K ARR last year just from referrals.

Worth a 30-min call to talk through the partner model?

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 34 · Mutual referral · Same ICP, different product

Subject: trading warm intros — {{your-co}} ↔ {{their-co}}

Hi {{firstname}},

We sell into the exact same buyer as you ({{ICP}}) but solve {{different-problem}}.
Zero overlap, full overlap on accounts.

Proposal: standing monthly call where we trade 5 warm intros each. We've done this with {{partner-1}} and {{partner-2}} – 30-50% close rate on referred deals because the buyer is already qualified.

Want to set up a 20-min intro call?

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 35 · Affiliate/influencer

Subject: {{their-channel}} affiliate program — {{X}}% recurring

Hi {{firstname}},

Big fan of your work on {{specific-content}}. Your audience overlaps tightly with our ICP.

We pay {{X}}% recurring on every signup that comes from your link. {{influencer-example}} is making ~\$8K/month from us. Branded landing page, custom promo code, full analytics dashboard.

Want me to send the affiliate setup link?

– {{your-firstname}}

8. Investor & Fundraising (Templates 36–40)

Template 36 · Cold investor · Pre-seed/seed

Subject: {{your-co}} — {{tagline}} — {{X}} ARR, {{Y}}% MoM

Hi {{firstname}},

I'm {{name}}, founder of {{your-co}}. We {{one-line-what-you-do}}.

Numbers: {{ARR}}, {{N customers}}, growing {{growth-rate}} MoM. {{notable-customer}} is on annual contract.

Raising {{round-size}} on {{terms}}. {{lead-investor-or-uncommitted}}.

Deck: {{link}} (4 pages). 15-min call if it's a fit?

– {{your-firstname}}

Subject: intro to {{target-investor}} via {{mutual}}?

Hi {{firstname}},

{{mutual-contact}} suggested I reach out — we're raising for {{your-co}} and they thought {{target-investor}} would be a strong fit given their {{thesis-area}} focus.

Forward-able blurb below if useful:

{{your-co}} — {{tagline}}. {{ARR}}, {{growth}}, {{notable-traction}}. Raising {{round}} at {{stage}}. Deck: {{link}}.

No pressure — only forward if you think it lands. Either way, thanks for any feedback.

— {{your-firstname}}

Subject: monthly investor update list — opt in?

Hi {{firstname}},

We're not raising right now, but I'd love to keep you on the monthly investor update list. Three sections: numbers, wins, asks.

Last update went out yesterday. Want me to forward it as a sample?

— {{your-firstname}}, founder of {{your-co}}

Subject: angel check + {{specific-help}} for {{your-co}}?

Hi {{firstname}},

Building {{your-co}} — {{tagline}}. Where you'd specifically be valuable beyond the check: {{specific-help-1}} and {{specific-help-2}}, both of which are adjacent to your {{their-experience}}.

Allocation reserved: {{check-size}} on {{terms}}. Deck: {{link}}.

15 min for a vibe check?

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 40 · LP / fund partner

Subject: {{their-thesis-area}} — fits your portfolio gap

Hi {{firstname}},

Saw your {{recent-investment}} — looks like {{thesis-area}} is core to the fund. {{your-co}} fills a specific gap in that thesis: {{thesis-gap}}.

Numbers: {{ARR}}, {{N-customers}}, {{growth-rate}}. {{notable-customer-1}} and {{notable-customer-2}} on annual contracts.

Raising {{round-size}}. Worth a first call?

Deck: {{link}}.

— {{your-firstname}}

9. Recruiting & Hiring (Templates 41–45)

Template 41 · Specific candidate · Senior IC

Subject: {{specific-project}} you shipped at {{previous-company}}

Hi {{firstname}},

Read your writeup on {{specific-project}} — exact problem we're hitting at {{your-co}} right now. We're hiring a {{role}} to own that next phase.

Stage: {{stage}}, {{ARR}}. Comp range: {{salary}} + {{equity}}. Stack: {{stack}}. Remote-first.

Worth a 25-min call? Even if the timing's wrong, would love your read on the problem.

— {{your-firstname}}, founder/{{role}} at {{your-co}}

Template 42 · Specific candidate · Sales hire

Subject: AE #1 at {{your-co}} — {{their-track-record}}

Hi {{firstname}},

You've already done what we need next: built {{their-result}} at {{their-company}} in {{timeframe}}.

We're hiring AE #1 — first 6 months, 100% inbound, \$1.2M pipeline ready, \$180K OTE 50/50. After that, you're hiring the team.

15 min to walk through?

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 43 · Passive candidate · Long shot

Subject: long shot — but worth asking

Hi {{firstname}},

Long shot — I know you're happy at {{their-company}}.

But: we just closed {{round}} and we're hiring our first {{role}}. The problem space ({{problem}}) is what you've been writing about for 2 years. The team you'd build is whatever you want it to be.

If there's a 5% chance you'd consider it, worth a no-pressure 30-min call.

— {{your-firstname}}, founder of {{your-co}}

Template 44 · Referral request to network

Subject: who's the best {{role}} you know?

Hi {{firstname}},

Hiring our first {{role}} at {{your-co}}. Asking 20 people I trust the same question: who's the best {{role}} you've worked with in the last 5 years?

Don't need a warm intro — just a name. We'll do the outreach.

Pays \$5K referral bonus if we hire someone you suggest.

— {{your-firstname}}

Template 45 · Reactivation · Past candidate

Subject: {{your-co}} 18 months later — different conversation

Hi {{firstname}},

We talked 18 months ago when we were 4 people and pre-revenue. You said the timing wasn't right — totally fair.

Update: {{ARR}}, {{growth}}, just closed {{round}} from {{lead-investor}}.

Different conversation now. Worth catching up for 25 min?

— {{your-firstname}}

10. Re-engagement & Reply-Bait (Templates 46–50)

Template 46 · Closing the loop · Cold lead 30-90 days old

Subject: closing the loop on {{topic}}

Hi {{firstname}},

Closing the loop on the conversation we started in {{month}}. You'd mentioned {{their-priority}} was on the roadmap.

If it's still relevant, we shipped {{new-feature}} two weeks ago that maps exactly to it. Happy to send a 2-min Loom.

If it's not relevant anymore, I'll close out the file – just reply with a "no" or ignore this one.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 47 · Permission to close · Stalled deal

Subject: should I close the file?

Hi {{firstname}},

Haven't heard back in 3 weeks – totally normal, I know things shift. Three options:

1. Still interested, just slammed → reply "alive"
2. Pushed to {{quarter}} → reply "{{quarter}}"
3. Killed the project → reply "close" and I'll stop emailing

Whichever it is, no pressure. Just want to keep the file clean.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 48 · One-question reply-bait

Subject: one question

{{firstname}} – quick: is {{specific-question}} still a priority for you in {{quarter}}?

Yes/no is fine. Will follow up with the right thing depending on the answer.

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 49 · Trigger event reactivation

Subject: saw {{trigger-event}} — relevant?

Hi {{firstname}},

Saw {{trigger-event}} – figured it might shift {{topic}} back onto the roadmap.

Last time we talked, the blocker was {{previous-blocker}}. Two things changed on our side since then: {{change-1}} and {{change-2}}, both of which address it.

Worth picking up the conversation?

– {{your-firstname}}

Template 50 · The "break-up" email

Subject: last one from me

Hi {{firstname}},

This is my last email — sending only because most "break-up" notes get more replies than the previous five emails combined, and I'm curious if it'll work.

If {{topic}} is still on your radar, hit reply with one word and I'll pick the thread back up. If not, I'll stop. No hard feelings either way.

— {{your-firstname}}

11. Follow-Up Sequences

The 3-Touch (B2B SaaS, mid-market)

1. **Day 0** — initial PAS or BAB email
2. **Day 3** — bump with 1 social proof point: "{{customer}} just hit {{result}} doing this"
3. **Day 7** — Template 47 (permission to close)

The 5-Touch (Enterprise, longer sales cycle)

1. **Day 0** — initial value-driven email (Templates 21–24)
2. **Day 4** — case study or ROI calculator
3. **Day 9** — different angle (champion-builder, Template 23)
4. **Day 16** — Loom or 1-pager attached
5. **Day 25** — break-up email (Template 50)

The 7-Touch (Strategic accounts, multi-stakeholder)

1. **Day 0** — strategic narrative (Template 24)
2. **Day 3** — multi-thread: reach out to second persona
3. **Day 7** — relevant content piece (no ask)
4. **Day 12** — quote-led email (Template 28)
5. **Day 18** — workshop offer (Template 30)
6. **Day 26** — peer or customer success story
7. **Day 35** — break-up

12. Personalization Cheat Sheet

Spend 30-90 seconds on each prospect. Pick ONE of these as your opener — never more than one, never zero.

- **Recent post / article** — quote one specific line, react to it
- **Recent product release** — name the feature, react to a design choice
- **Funding announcement** — congratulate, then connect to a specific implication
- **Job change** — reference the move, ask one question about the new role
- **Conference talk** — name a slide or moment, build on it
- **Their stack (visible)** — name a tool they use, connect to your offer
- **Their customers** — name one, draw a parallel
- **Their location** — only if you have a real reason (event, meet-up, customer there)

What does NOT count as personalization: "I see you're the {{role}} at {{company}}"/ "I noticed {{company}} is in {{vertical}}"/ "Hope you're having a great week!" — these signal a blast.

13. Deliverability Checklist

1. **Warm up new domains for 14+ days.** Send 5–10 manual emails/day from the domain before scaling. Use Lemwarm, Mailwarm, or Warmup Inbox.
2. **Set up SPF, DKIM, and DMARC.** All three. DMARC at minimum p=none for monitoring.
3. **Custom tracking domain.** Don't share the platform's default — get a CNAME on your own domain (e.g., links.yourco.com).
4. **Daily volume cap: 30–50 per inbox.** Use multiple inboxes if you need more, never one inbox at 200/day.
5. **No images or attachments in cold emails.** Plain text, one link max.
6. **Avoid spam trigger words.** "FREE", "guaranteed", "act now", "limited time", "\$\$\$".
7. **Verify every email before sending.** NeverBounce, ZeroBounce, MillionVerifier. Bounce rate under 3%.
8. **Unsubscribe link on follow-ups.** Required for CAN-SPAM. Plain text, end of email.
9. **Reply rate target: 3-7%.** Below 3% means your list, copy, or both are off.

14. Legal: CAN-SPAM & GDPR Quick Reference

CAN-SPAM (US)

- Identify yourself + your physical mailing address (in footer)
- Don't use deceptive subject lines or "From" addresses
- Honor opt-out requests within 10 business days
- Include a clear unsubscribe mechanism (visible, working)

GDPR (EU prospects)

- Cold B2B email is allowed under "legitimate interest" if the recipient is a relevant business contact
- You must include the same unsubscribe + identification info as CAN-SPAM
- Keep a record of why each contact is on your list
- If a recipient asks for their data deleted (Right to Erasure), comply within 30 days

This is not legal advice. Consult counsel for your specific jurisdiction before scaling cold outreach. Rules differ in California (CCPA), Canada (CASL), and the UK (PECR).